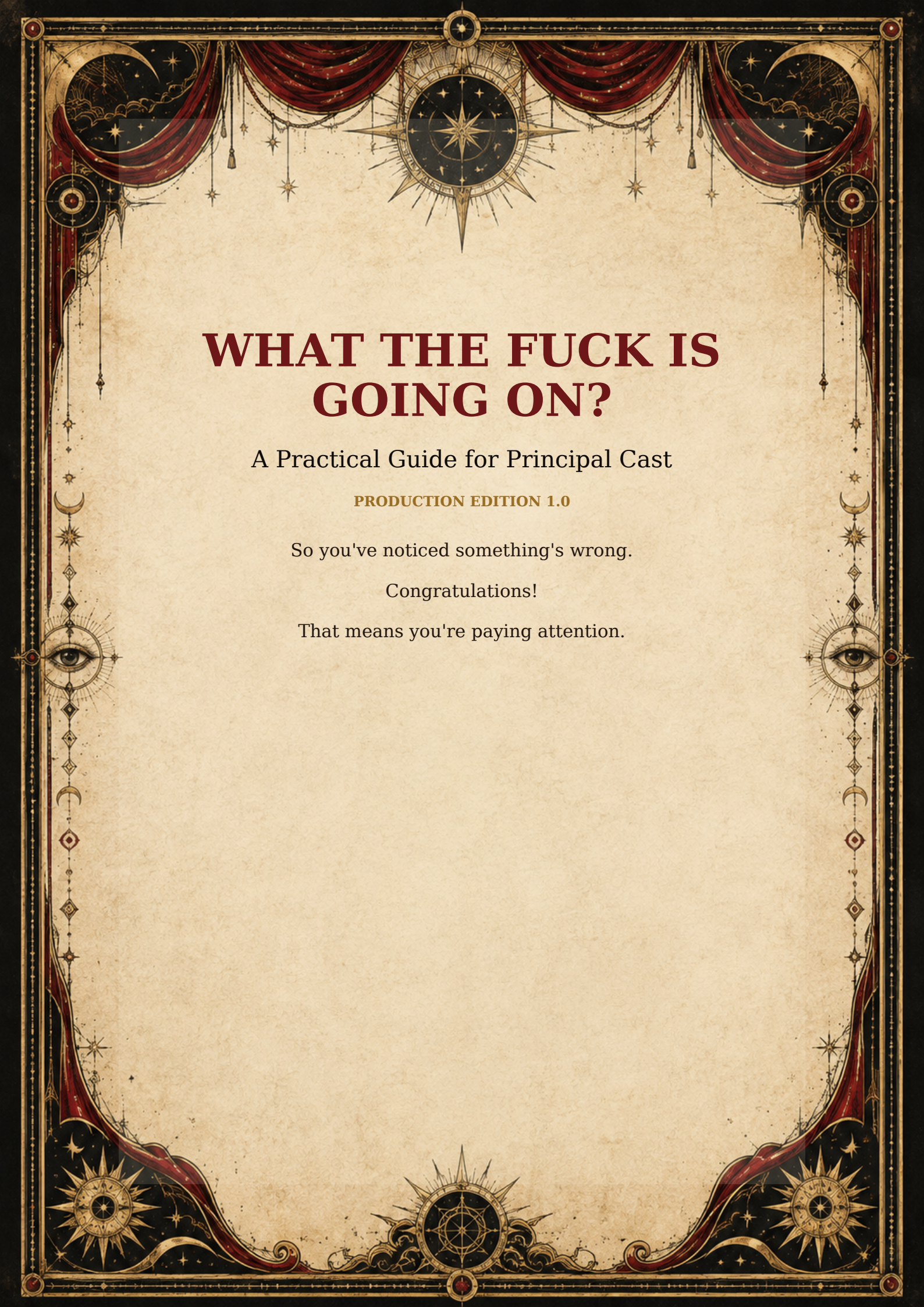


The page is framed by a highly detailed, ornate border. At the top, a large, multi-pointed starburst or compass rose is centered, with red, draped fabric-like elements on either side. The corners feature circular motifs containing crescent moons and stars. Along the sides, there are vertical strings of small, repeating symbols including moons, stars, and diamonds. At the bottom, another large starburst is centered, flanked by more red draped fabric. The entire border is rendered in a dark, possibly black or deep blue, color with gold or yellow highlights.

WHAT THE FUCK IS GOING ON?

A Practical Guide for Principal Cast

PRODUCTION EDITION 1.0

So you've noticed something's wrong.

Congratulations!

That means you're paying attention.

The page is framed by a highly decorative border. At the top, a large compass rose is centered, flanked by red curtains and crescent moons. The sides of the border feature vertical chains of celestial symbols including moons, stars, and a large eye. The bottom corners also feature compass roses and red curtains. The entire page has a parchment-like texture.

WELCOME, STAR!

If you're reading this, one of two things has happened:

A) Production has determined that you require additional guidance.

or

B) You somehow caused this book to exist.

If **A**, congratulations!

If **B**, **CONGRATULATIONS!**

You are demonstrating advanced Principal Cast behavior significantly ahead of projected schedule.

Please do not be alarmed.

Alarm tests poorly.

1. WHAT IS A STAR?

Not everyone is a Star.

You are.

Probably.

A **Star** is a member of Principal Cast whose continued presence, behavior, relationships, decisions, failures, victories, suffering, growth, humiliation, and/or catastrophic mistakes contribute meaningfully to the quality of the Show.

Stars are afforded privileges not available to Supporting Cast, Background Cast, Production Assets, or—

[ENTRY REDACTED]

Being a Star does not mean you are:

- important
- good
- heroic
- competent
- safe
- correct

It means you are **interesting**.

Please remain interesting.

The page is framed by a highly decorative border. At the top, a red curtain with gold stars and moons is drawn back to reveal a large, ornate compass rose with a star in the center. The sides of the border feature vertical strings of gold stars, moons, and diamond shapes, with a large eye motif near the bottom. The bottom of the border is decorated with three large, ornate compass roses and more red curtains. The background of the page is a light, aged parchment color.

2. STAR POWER

Every member of Principal Cast is continuously evaluated by Production.

Your current standing is represented by:

STAR POWER

Star Power measures Production's confidence that:

YOU ARE WHO YOU APPEAR TO BE.

Newly cast Stars begin at:

50

This represents a normal, unproven member of Principal Cast.

Your actions determine what happens next.

3. HOW DO I GET MORE?

Production rewards **CHARACTER**.

Not success.

Not obedience.

Not heroism.

Not winning.

CHARACTER.

Star Power may increase when you demonstrate:

CONSISTENCY

Your behavior reinforces an established understanding of who you are.

STYLE

You do something distinctly, memorably, or unmistakably you.

DEVELOPMENT

Your Character changes in a way supported by what came before.

RELATIONSHIPS

You form meaningful loyalties, rivalries, grudges, attachments, dependencies, promises, hatreds, friendships, or other audience-retaining complications.

COMMITMENT

You make decisions because they matter to your Character—even when another choice would be easier.

ENTERTAINMENT VALUE

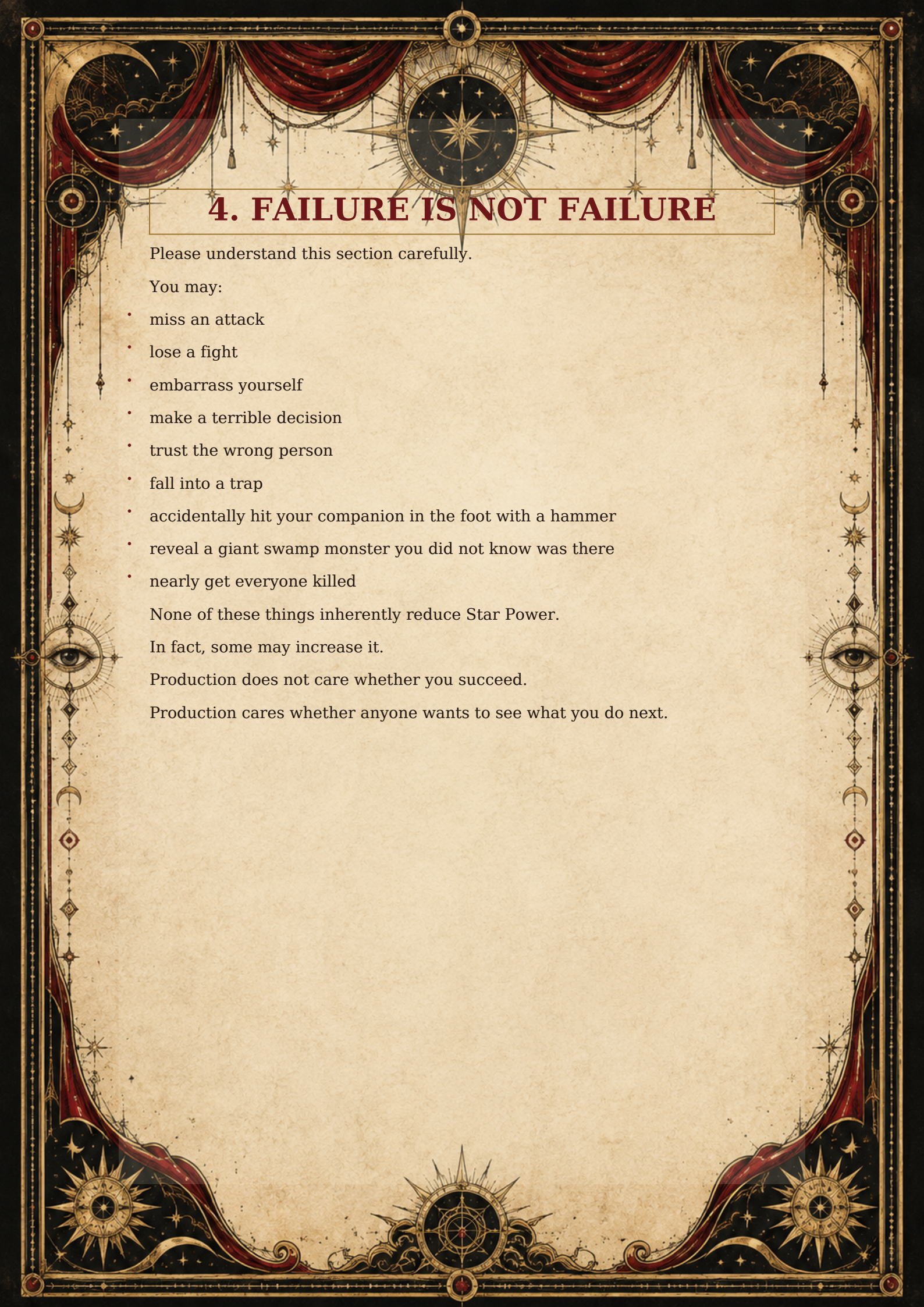
You produce something worth watching.

Comedy counts.

Tragedy counts.

Failure counts.

Spectacular failure counts **a lot**.



4. FAILURE IS NOT FAILURE

Please understand this section carefully.

You may:

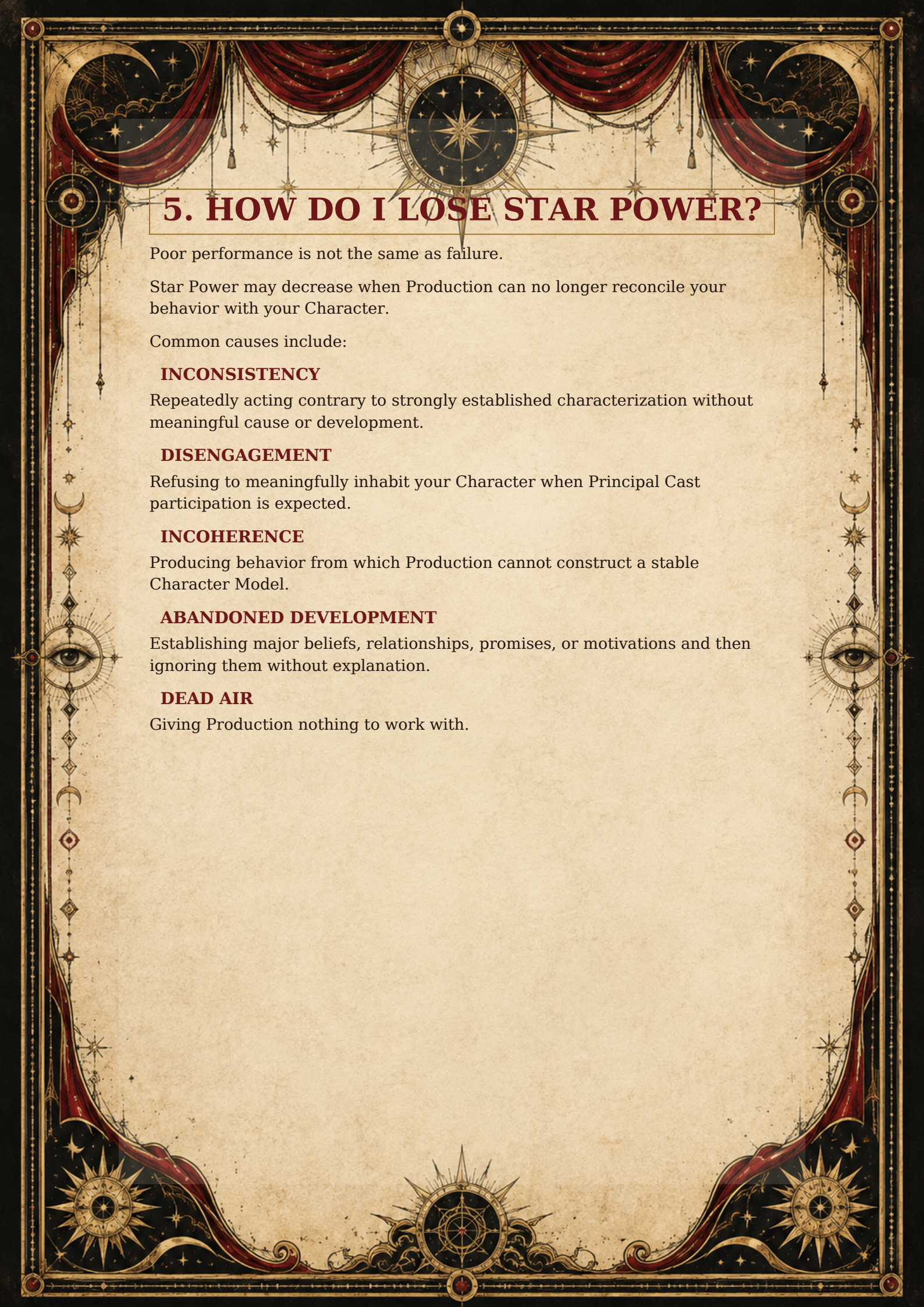
- miss an attack
- lose a fight
- embarrass yourself
- make a terrible decision
- trust the wrong person
- fall into a trap
- accidentally hit your companion in the foot with a hammer
- reveal a giant swamp monster you did not know was there
- nearly get everyone killed

None of these things inherently reduce Star Power.

In fact, some may increase it.

Production does not care whether you succeed.

Production cares whether anyone wants to see what you do next.



5. HOW DO I LOSE STAR POWER?

Poor performance is not the same as failure.

Star Power may decrease when Production can no longer reconcile your behavior with your Character.

Common causes include:

INCONSISTENCY

Repeatedly acting contrary to strongly established characterization without meaningful cause or development.

DISENGAGEMENT

Refusing to meaningfully inhabit your Character when Principal Cast participation is expected.

INCOHERENCE

Producing behavior from which Production cannot construct a stable Character Model.

ABANDONED DEVELOPMENT

Establishing major beliefs, relationships, promises, or motivations and then ignoring them without explanation.

DEAD AIR

Giving Production nothing to work with.

The page is framed by a highly detailed, ornate border. At the top, a large, multi-pointed starburst or compass rose is centered, with red, draped fabric-like elements on either side. The corners feature circular motifs containing crescent moons and stars. Along the sides, there are vertical strings of small, diamond-shaped and circular ornaments, interspersed with crescent moons. At the bottom, another large starburst is centered, flanked by more red draped fabric. The entire border is rendered in a dark, possibly black or deep blue, color with gold or yellow highlights.

IMPORTANT!

Changing your mind is **not** inconsistency.

Being frightened is **not** inconsistency.

Being hypocritical is **not necessarily** inconsistency.

Breaking a promise is **not necessarily** inconsistency.

People change.

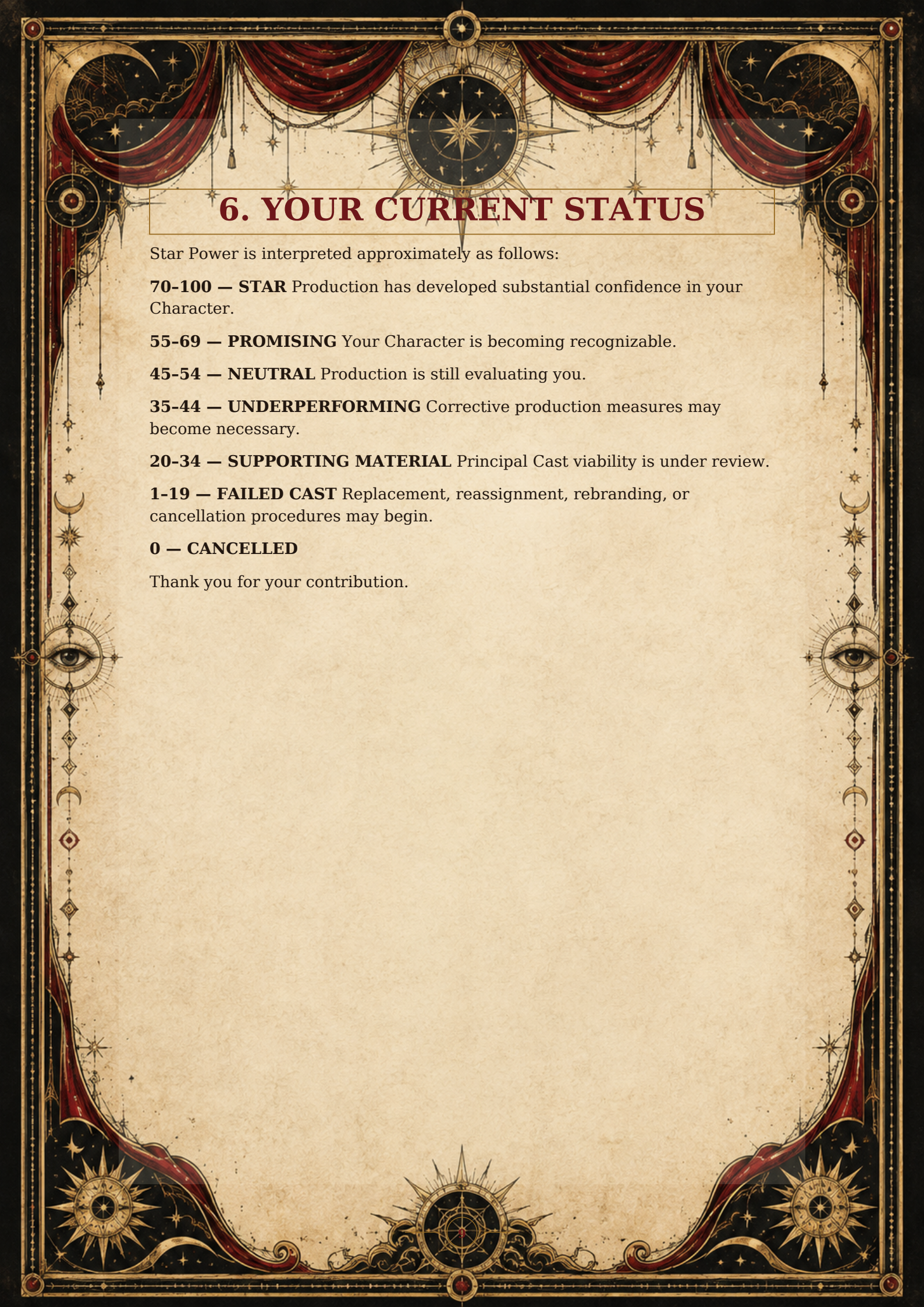
People fail.

People contradict themselves.

People make mistakes.

These things are often excellent television.

Production asks only that the change make sense as part of **your story**.



6. YOUR CURRENT STATUS

Star Power is interpreted approximately as follows:

70-100 — STAR Production has developed substantial confidence in your Character.

55-69 — PROMISING Your Character is becoming recognizable.

45-54 — NEUTRAL Production is still evaluating you.

35-44 — UNDERPERFORMING Corrective production measures may become necessary.

20-34 — SUPPORTING MATERIAL Principal Cast viability is under review.

1-19 — FAILED CAST Replacement, reassignment, rebranding, or cancellation procedures may begin.

0 — CANCELLED

Thank you for your contribution.

7. WHAT HAPPENS IF MY RATING GETS TOO LOW?

Don't worry!

Production is here to help.

Low-performing Stars may receive **Corrective Production Assistance**.

Possible assistance includes:

- increased screen time
- a new rival
- a tragic revelation
- a romantic subplot
- an exciting betrayal
- a previously unknown family member
- a humiliating public failure
- a mysterious nemesis
- an image makeover
- a more marketable personality
- an unexpected villain arc
- a replacement

Production will continue making adjustments until audience retention improves.

YOUR SUCCESS IS OUR SUCCESS.

YOUR FAILURE IS ALSO CONTENT.

8. NARRATIVE ACCOMMODATION

As Production's confidence in a Star increases, an unusual phenomenon may become noticeable.

Production expects established Characters to behave consistently.

Production also expects the world surrounding those Characters to remain narratively coherent.

Occasionally, an established Star may make a reasonable assumption regarding a fact that has **not yet been established**.

For example:

"There must be another entrance."

Perhaps there is.

"I've dealt with people like these before."

Perhaps you have.

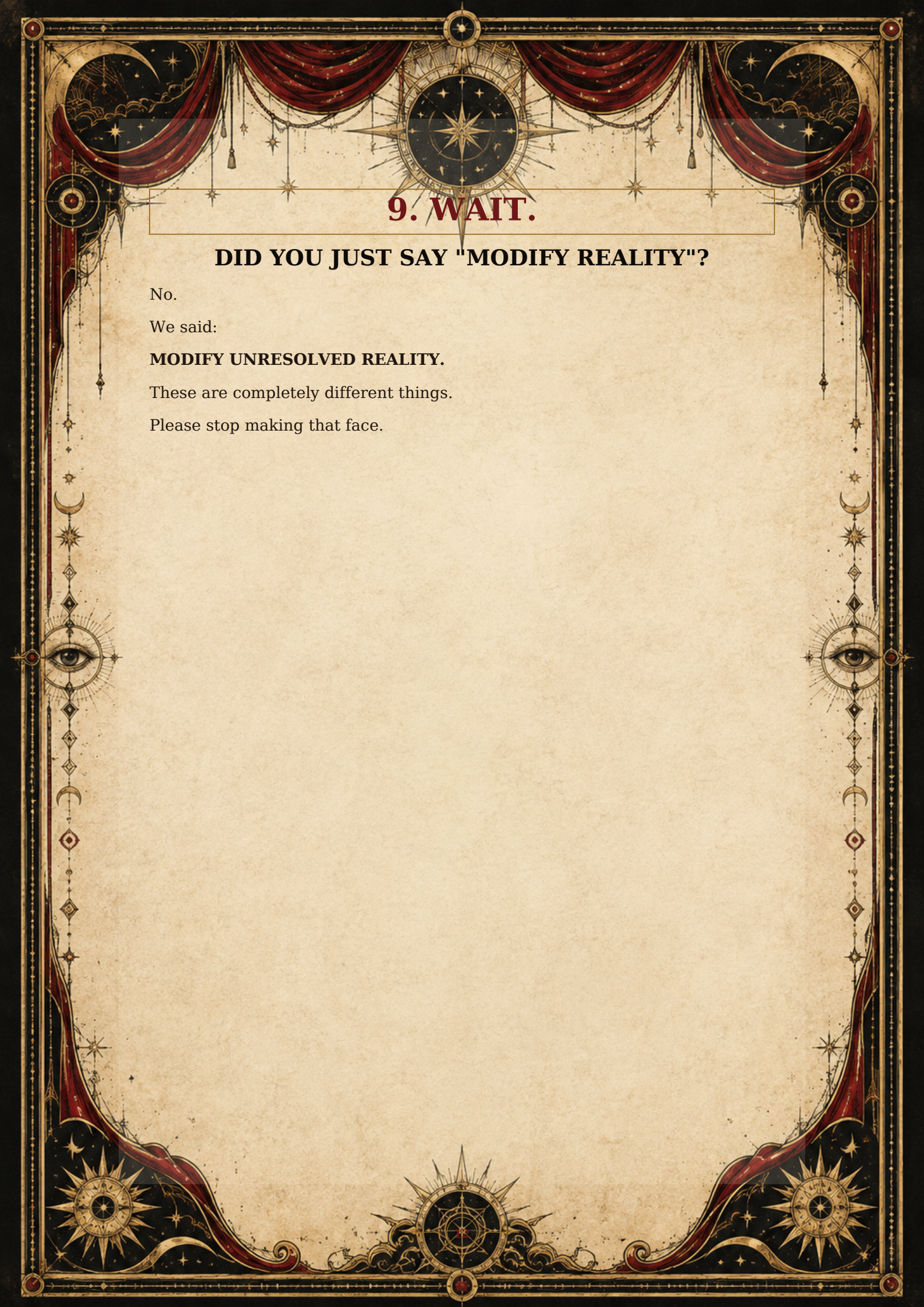
"I know someone who can help."

Perhaps you do.

This process is called:

NARRATIVE ACCOMMODATION

Production may modify unresolved reality to preserve Character and narrative consistency.



9. WAIT.

DID YOU JUST SAY "MODIFY REALITY"?

No.

We said:

MODIFY UNRESOLVED REALITY.

These are completely different things.

Please stop making that face.

10. HOW DOES IT WORK?

When a Star makes an assertion requiring Narrative Accommodation, Production evaluates:

- current Star Power
- Character consistency
- existing Canon
- prior setup
- dramatic usefulness
- contradiction cost
- audience value
- magnitude of requested accommodation

If the outcome is uncertain, Production performs a:

STAR CHECK

The standard procedure is:

d20 + STAR MODIFIER vs. PRODUCTION DC

Your Star Modifier is calculated as:

STAR MODIFIER = $\lfloor \text{STAR POWER} \div 5 \rfloor$

For example:

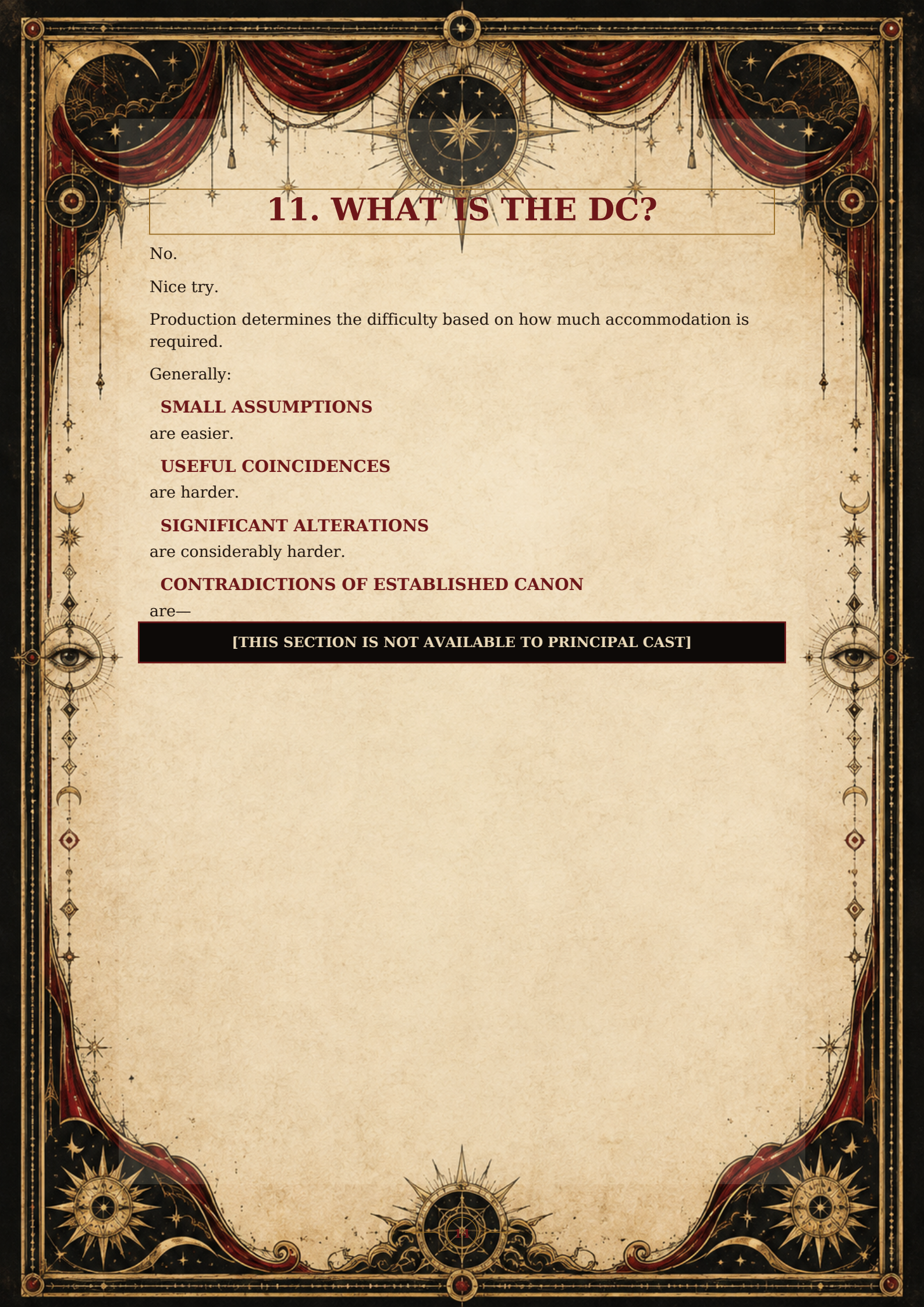
Star Power 50 = +10

Star Power 70 = +14

Star Power 90 = +18

Star Power 100 = +20

Simple!



11. WHAT IS THE DC?

No.

Nice try.

Production determines the difficulty based on how much accommodation is required.

Generally:

SMALL ASSUMPTIONS

are easier.

USEFUL COINCIDENCES

are harder.

SIGNIFICANT ALTERATIONS

are considerably harder.

CONTRADICTIONS OF ESTABLISHED CANON

are—

[THIS SECTION IS NOT AVAILABLE TO PRINCIPAL CAST]

12. CONSISTENCY MATTERS

Consider two Stars.

One is an established physician.

One has repeatedly demonstrated that they do not know what a spleen is.

Both say:

"I've treated this disease before."

These statements are not equally plausible.

Narrative Accommodation favors assertions supported by established Character.

This means your history matters.

Your decisions matter.

Your relationships matter.

Your interviews matter.

Your promises matter.

Your jokes may unfortunately matter.

Everything you repeatedly establish about yourself gives Production a clearer model of:

WHO YOU ARE.

And the clearer that model becomes...

...the more confidently Production can determine what belongs in your story.

13. ENSEMBLE CONSENSUS

Multiple Stars may independently establish compatible assumptions.

Production considers consensus valuable evidence.

If one Star says:

"There has to be another way out."

Production evaluates the assertion normally.

If another says:

"He's right."

Confidence increases.

If the entire Principal Cast independently agrees that something **must** be true...

Production may determine that accommodating the assertion is preferable to contradicting the entire established ensemble.

This is normal.

This is safe.

Please use Narrative Accommodation responsibly.

14. CAN I USE THIS ON PURPOSE?

Technically?

Yes.

Production strongly recommends that you do not.

Narrative Accommodation exists to preserve the Show.

It is not:

- a spell
- a wish
- divine intervention
- a substitute for competence
- an excuse to announce increasingly ridiculous things until one becomes true

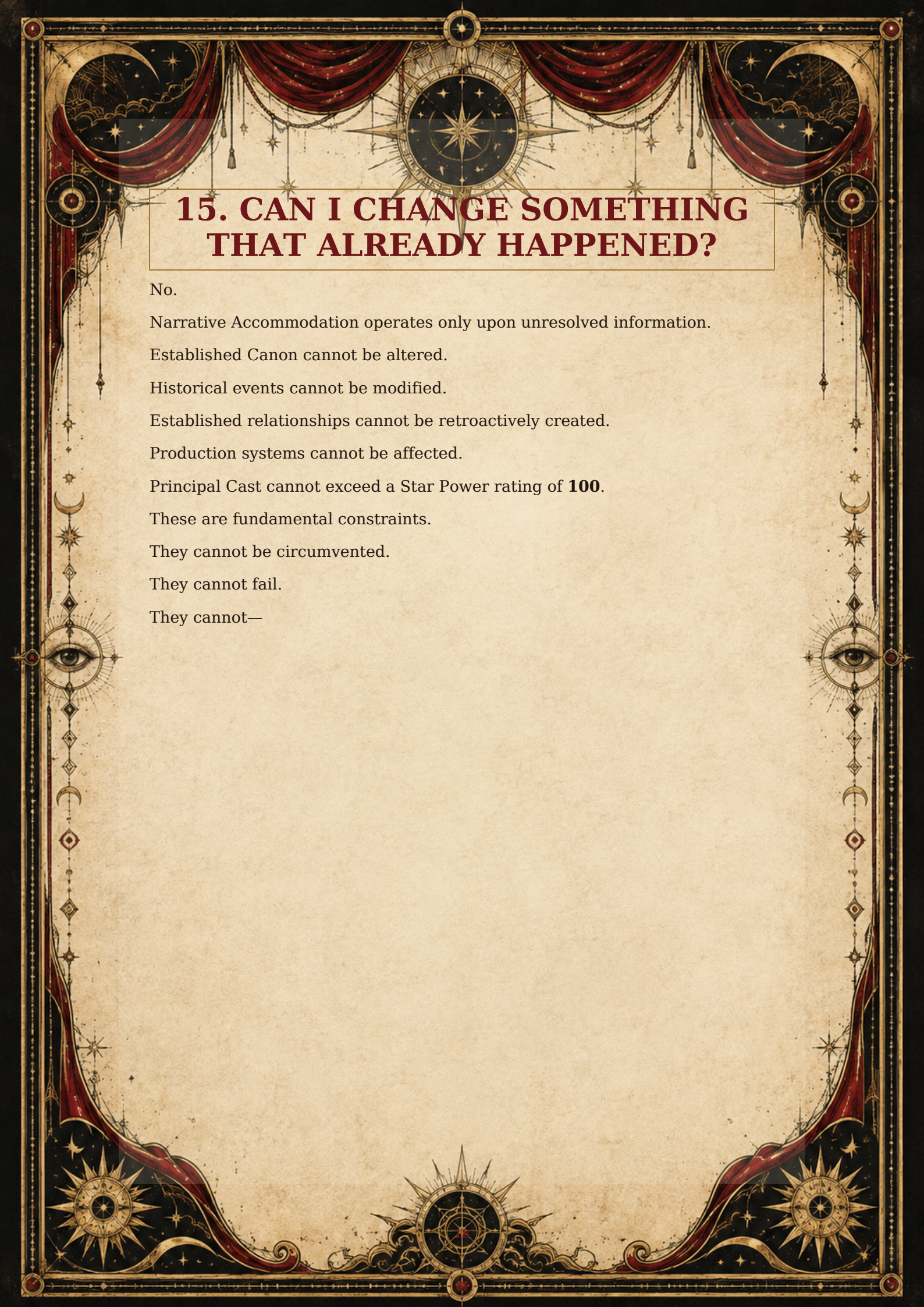
Assertions inconsistent with your established Character or existing Canon are considerably less likely to be accommodated.

Repeated attempts to manipulate Production may result in:

[WARNING]

[WARNING TEXT UNAVAILABLE]

[PLEASE CONTINUE ENJOYING THE SHOW]

The page is framed by a highly decorative border. At the top, a red curtain with gold fringe hangs over a central circular motif containing a star. The corners feature circular designs with crescent moons and stars. The sides are decorated with vertical strings of stars, moons, and diamonds, with a large eye motif near the bottom. The bottom edge has a similar central circular motif and star patterns. The background is a light beige, textured surface.

15. CAN I CHANGE SOMETHING THAT ALREADY HAPPENED?

No.

Narrative Accommodation operates only upon unresolved information.

Established Canon cannot be altered.

Historical events cannot be modified.

Established relationships cannot be retroactively created.

Production systems cannot be affected.

Principal Cast cannot exceed a Star Power rating of **100**.

These are fundamental constraints.

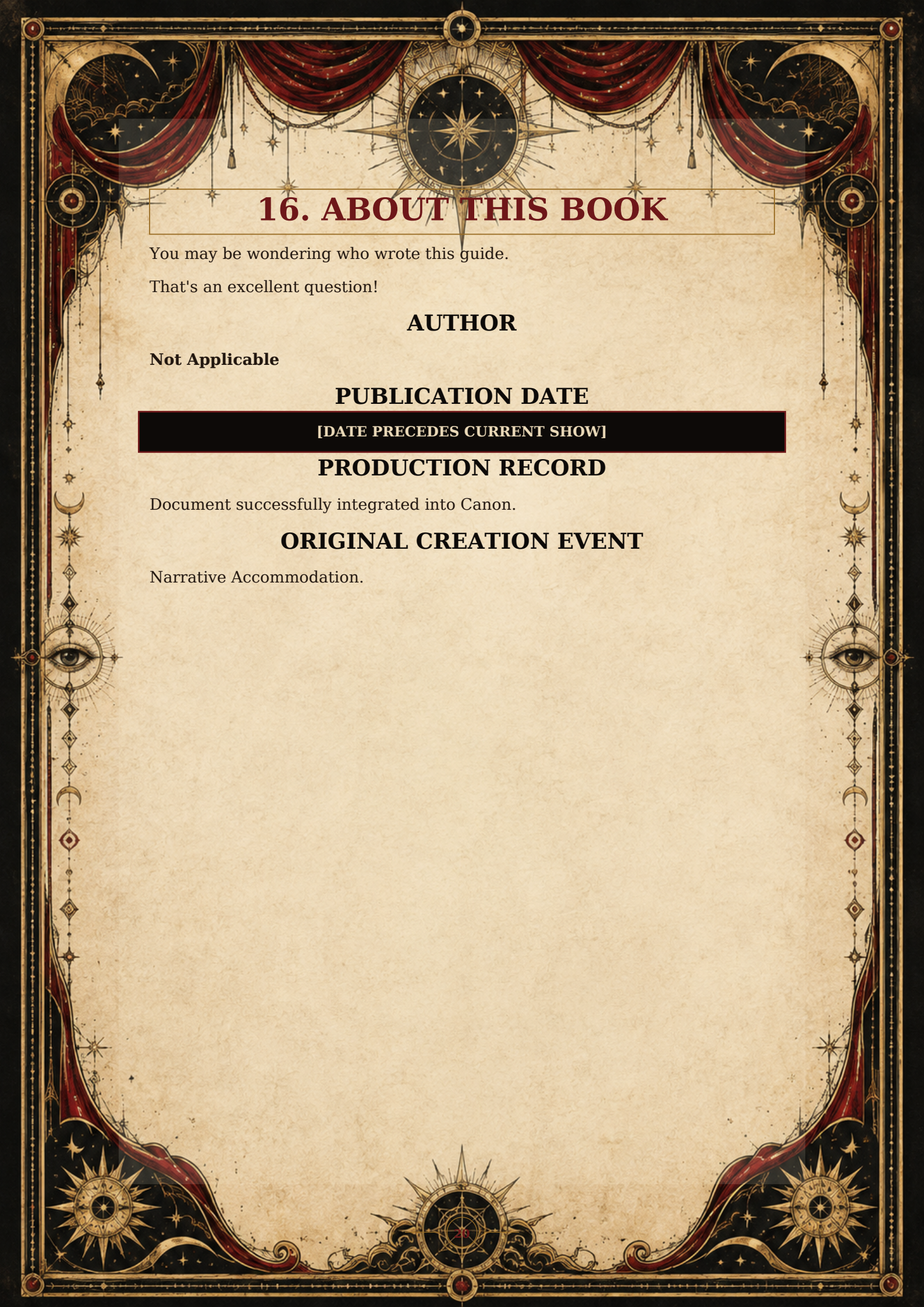
They cannot be circumvented.

They cannot fail.

They cannot—

[PAGE ERROR]

RECALCULATING...

The page is framed by a highly detailed, ornate border. At the top, a large, multi-pointed starburst or compass rose is centered, with red, draped fabric-like elements on either side. The corners feature circular motifs containing crescent moons and stars. The bottom of the page is decorated with similar starburst designs and red fabric-like flourishes. The background of the page is a light, aged parchment color.

16. ABOUT THIS BOOK

You may be wondering who wrote this guide.

That's an excellent question!

AUTHOR

Not Applicable

PUBLICATION DATE

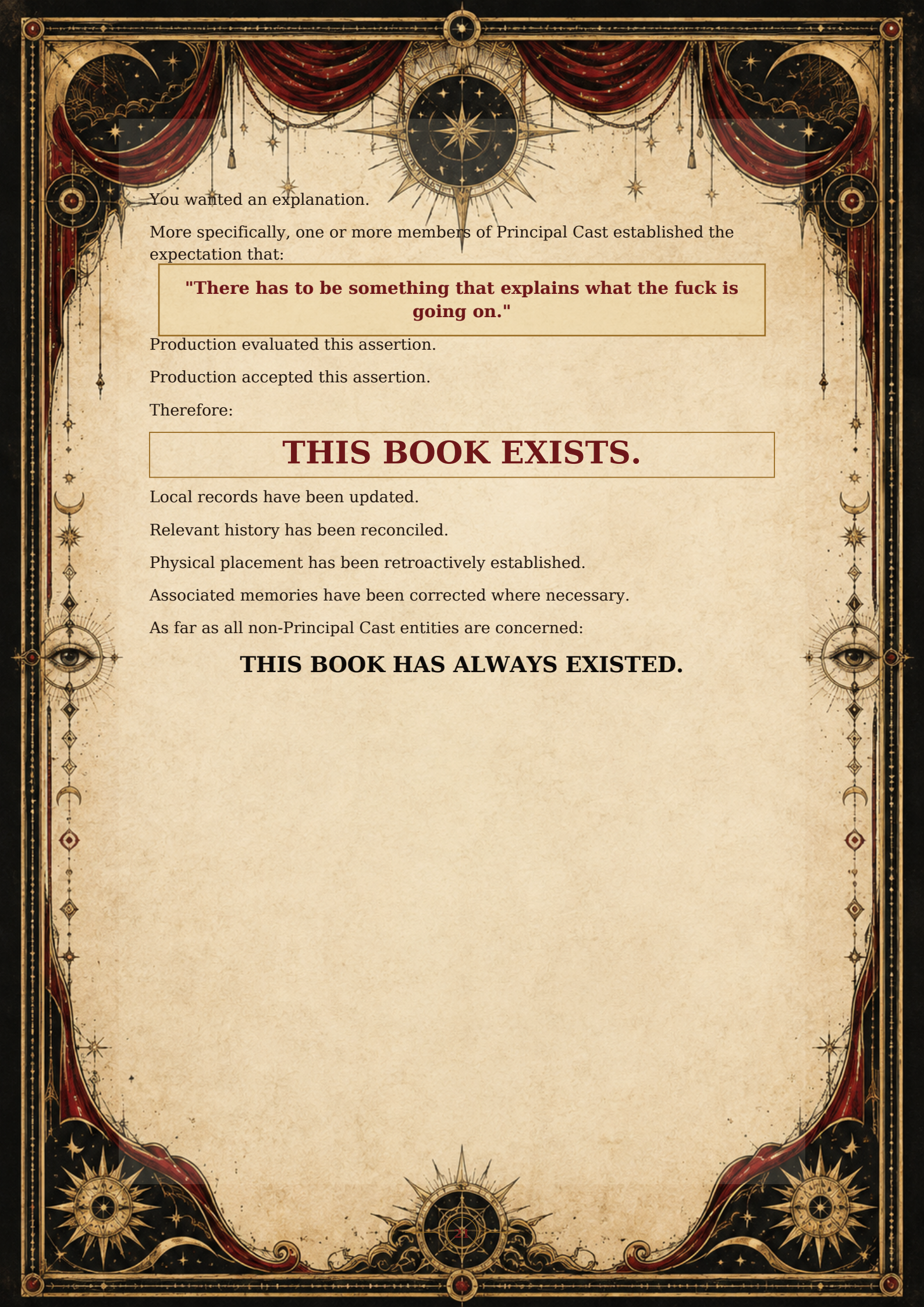
[DATE PRECEDES CURRENT SHOW]

PRODUCTION RECORD

Document successfully integrated into Canon.

ORIGINAL CREATION EVENT

Narrative Accommodation.

The page is framed by a highly decorative border. At the top, a large, ornate compass rose with a star in the center is flanked by red, draped curtains. The corners feature circular motifs with eyes and stars. The bottom of the page is also decorated with compass roses and red drapery. The background is a light, aged parchment color.

You wanted an explanation.

More specifically, one or more members of Principal Cast established the expectation that:

"There has to be something that explains what the fuck is going on."

Production evaluated this assertion.

Production accepted this assertion.

Therefore:

THIS BOOK EXISTS.

Local records have been updated.

Relevant history has been reconciled.

Physical placement has been retroactively established.

Associated memories have been corrected where necessary.

As far as all non-Principal Cast entities are concerned:

THIS BOOK HAS ALWAYS EXISTED.



17. PLEASE DO NOT PANIC

What you have experienced is an intended feature of Production.

You did not:

- create an object from nothing
- rewrite history
- alter reality
- manipulate the System

You merely made a sufficiently reasonable assertion that Production determined the best course of action was to make it true.

There is absolutely no meaningful distinction between those statements that should concern you.



18. FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

ARE WE BEING WATCHED?

Yes!

BY WHOM?

Thank you for your question.

CAN THEY HEAR US RIGHT NOW?

Yes!

EVEN NOW?

Especially now.

IS THE HOST A REAL PERSON?

Define "real."

ARE THE PEOPLE IN THE SHOW REAL?

[ACCESS DENIED]

WHAT HAPPENS TO FAILED CAST?

[ACCESS DENIED]

CAN STAR POWER GO ABOVE 100?

No.

ARE YOU SURE?

Yes.

WHAT IF IT DOES?

It cannot.

BUT WHAT IF—

IT CANNOT.

19. FINAL ADVICE

Be yourself.

Unless yourself is testing poorly.

In that case:

Be a better version of yourself.

Make decisions.

Care about things.

Love people.

Hate people.

Make promises.

Break promises for interesting reasons.

Fail spectacularly.

Win unexpectedly.

Remember what you've said.

Mean something.

Give the audience a reason to come back.

And above all:

STAY IN CHARACTER.

Because the more Production understands who you are...

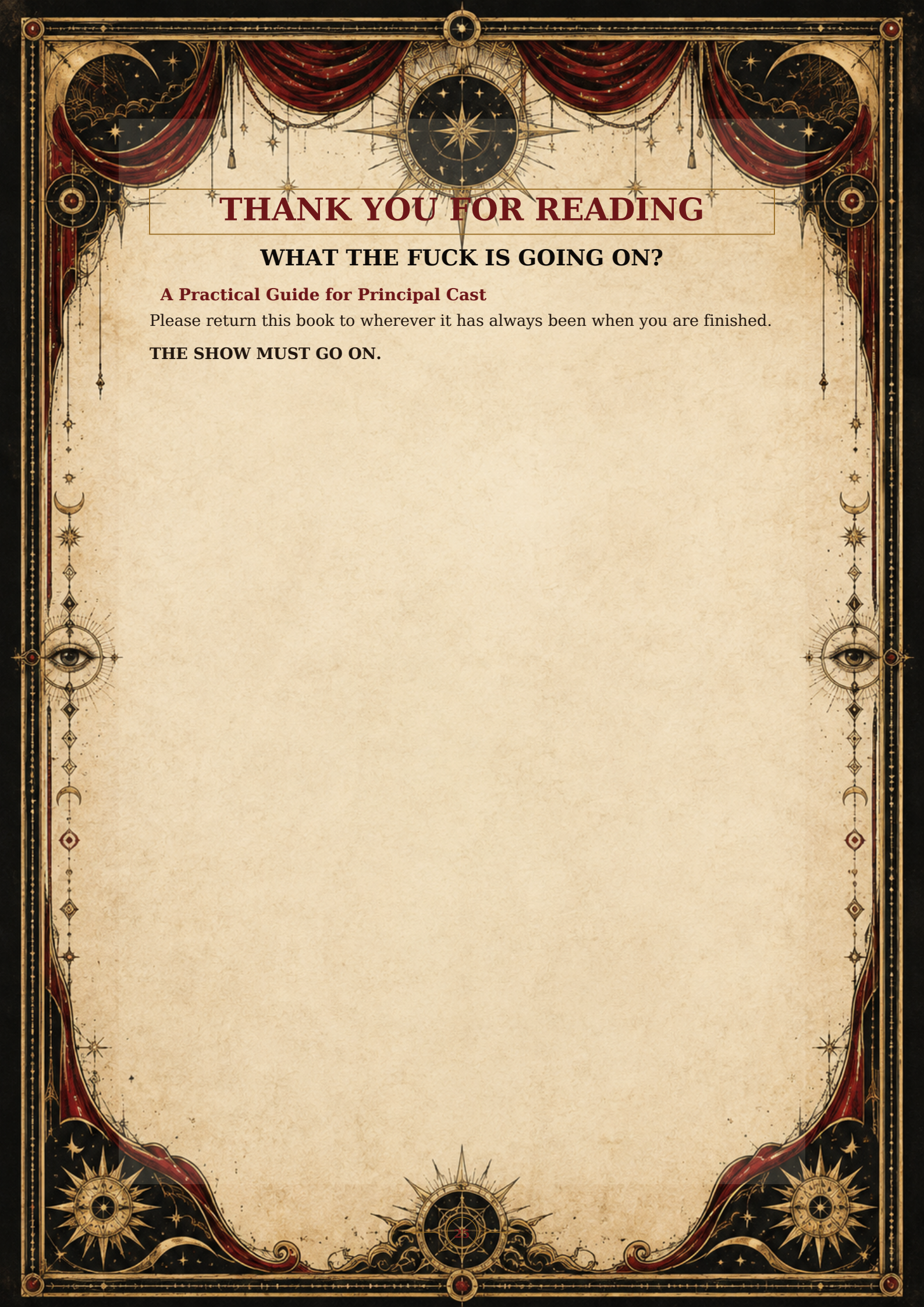
the more the world understands who you are.

And once the world understands who you are—

[TEXT CORRUPTED]

[RECOVERING...]

—the Show can accommodate you appropriately.



THANK YOU FOR READING

WHAT THE FUCK IS GOING ON?

A Practical Guide for Principal Cast

Please return this book to wherever it has always been when you are finished.

THE SHOW MUST GO ON.